

on a red carpet following her wedding at Palacio de las Duenas, her opulent fifteenth-century residence in the cobblestoned old quarter of Seville. Her new husband stood by, ready to catch her if she were to fall over.

Perhaps the duchess is entitled to her fun. But this is the sort of thing that makes a wealthy aristocratic family nervous, and for good reason. It could have gone very wrong.

BEWARE OF PARASITES

Tulip. Armchair. Duck.

The second richest woman in the world was unable to remember these three words for more than a few seconds, according to experts who performed a court-ordered mental health test on her. She was also incapable of telling them where she was, what day it was, and her age.

Liliane Bettencourt, who is now 90 years old and one of France's wealthiest citizens, is the heiress to the \$23.5 billion L'Oréal fortune.

The mental health experts concluded that the cosmetics billionaire suffers from "mixed dementia" and "moderately severe" Alzheimer's disease and that she was in the midst of a "slow and progressive process of cerebral degeneration."¹¹

As a result, in October 2011, a French judge placed her physical well-being under the guardianship of her grandson. And her estranged daughter, Françoise Bettencourt Meyers, together with her grandsons are ordered to look after her wealth and property.

We don't have all the evidence in the case. But we think it is certainly very possible that Liliane Bettencourt has been the victim of parasitic advisers, who have been lining their own pockets at the expense of her estate.

For years, details of this mother-daughter feud have filled the French papers. Bettencourt Meyers has been filing court appeals since 2008 to have her mother made a ward of the court because of mental incapacity. But her mother's lawyers were able to successfully block her attempts in the courts.

The new evidence of Bettencourt's mental state suggests that her lawyer and legal "protector," Pascal Wilhelm, and the head of her family office,